PROMISE & PRACTICE · UNIT 3 · CHAPTER 2 ASSIGNMENT

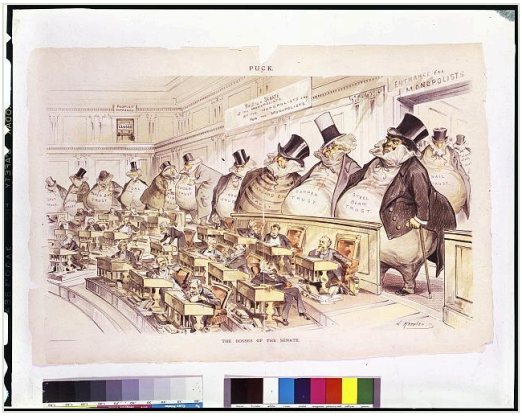
Robber Baron or Captain of Industry?

Evidence sort · Skill: The label is the argument

Name _____ **Period** _____ **Date** _____

WHAT I CAN DO TODAY

I can sort evidence about business leaders and choose a label I can defend.



"The Bosses of the Senate" — the trusts loom over the U.S. Senate — cartoon by Joseph Keppler, Puck, 1889, public domain (Library of Congress)

Directions

Historians use two very different labels for the business giants of this era. Sort each fact, then pick a label for one man and defend it.

1 Sort the evidence

Does each fact support calling the man a robber baron, a captain of industry, or could it be both?

	STATEMENT	ROBBER BARON	CAPTAIN OF INDUSTRY	COULD BE BOTH
1	Carnegie's mills made steel cheap enough to build railroads and bridges across the country.	☐	☐	☐
2	Carnegie gave away about 90 percent of his fortune, paying for more than 2,500 libraries.	☐	☐	☐
3	At Carnegie's Homestead mill in 1892, managers cut wages and hired armed Pinkerton guards against strikers.	☐	☐	☐
4	By 1880, Rockefeller's Standard Oil controlled about 90 percent of the nation's oil refining.	☐	☐	☐
5	Standard Oil got secret discounts from railroads that its competitors could not get.	☐	☐	☐
6	Rockefeller's refineries made kerosene cheap, so more families could light their homes at night.	☐	☐	☐

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	STATEMENT	ROBBER BARON	CAPTAIN OF INDUSTRY	COULD BE BOTH
7	George Pullman built a planned town for his workers with brick homes, parks, and a library.	☐	☐	☐
8	In 1893–94, Pullman cut his workers' wages but did not lower the rent in his town.	☐	☐	☐

2 Choose your label

Pick Carnegie, Rockefeller, or Pullman. Which label fits him better?

My choice and my label:

Give two pieces of evidence from the sort.

What would someone who disagrees with you say?

Finished? Turn in this paper the way your teacher asks.

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